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Weekly
Record

BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION
CARREFOUR AND MAGNUM CASH&CARRY

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Ownership and business model

Weekly Record 3 • Carrefour and Magnum Cash&Carry

1 Concept

Ownership affects control, finance and risk. A sole proprietor has direct control but unlimited personal liability. Partners share resources and decisions; liability depends on the form. A corporation is a separate legal entity, with ownership held through shares. Entrepreneurs seek opportunities under uncertainty, while intrapreneurs develop ideas within an existing organisation [1].

Concept Check, section 5.1: what differentiates an entrepreneur from a small-business owner? Entrepreneurship emphasises innovation and growth; an owner may instead prioritise a stable operation. At Magnum, an employee proposing a forecasting trial would be acting as an intrapreneur.

2 Application

Carrefour SA operates an international retail model that includes franchises [2]. Magnum identifies itself as an LLP [15]. Kazakhstan’s partnership law generally limits participants’ risk to their contributions, subject to exceptions, and makes their general meeting the highest governing body [18]. This legal form does not reveal Magnum’s beneficial owners or its internal approval limits.

Magnum creates value by making goods available to households and business customers [14]. Sales generate revenue; purchases, wages, premises and logistics consume it. Forecasting could reduce tied-up stock and waste, while catalogue search could make shopping easier. Both also add software and staff costs. Magnum Club already provides digital loyalty interaction [15], although the policy does not establish AI deployment.

Table 3 AI Business Model Stress Test

Model element	Carrefour evidence	Stress on Magnum	Verdict	Local condition and test
Customer search	Hopla and later shopping services link questions to products. [12], [19]	Recommendations may point to unavailable goods.	ADAPT	Test Kazakh and Russian questions against the local catalogue. Compare successful searches; keep staff help.
Stock planning	SAS describes AI for demand forecasts and ordering. [20]	Stock errors or promotions make forecasts unreliable.	PILOT	Compare stockouts, waste and correction time with current ordering. Category managers approve orders.

Model element	Carrefour evidence	Stress on Magnum	Verdict	Local condition and test
Supplier relationships	Ethics charter covers conduct and reporting. [21]	Written commitments may not change purchasing.	ADOPT	Apply accountability through existing Magnum rules. [22] Track resolution and repeated complaints.
Loyalty offers	Later services use purchase histories. [19]	Extra data may add intrusion and cost without enough benefit.	DELAY	Review purpose, access and customer choices. Demonstrate value beyond existing Magnum Club offers. [7], [15]
Order approval	A proposed extension beyond the documented comparison.	Automatic commitments could magnify mistakes.	REJECT	Keep a named manager and manual ordering for this trial. This is the proposed Magnum boundary.

Source: company and vendor publications cited in the table. Verdicts and test conditions are proposed for Magnum.

Changed assumption: the trial finds that recorded stock differs from shelf stock during promotions. The forecasting verdict changes from PILOT to DELAY: category managers first reconcile stock and promotion records, then retest against current ordering. Search remains limited to items with checked availability. Expansion requires savings from fewer lost sales and less waste to exceed software, integration, training and correction costs. These are decision criteria, not measured Magnum results.

This test supports Capstone section 3 and Business Report section 3. It narrows the investment case: improve availability with accountable staff before using more customer data. Preparation and source checks were supported by Codex.

References

[1] L. J. Gitman et al., “Introduction to Business,” 2nd ed., OpenStax, 2026.

[2] Carrefour, “Q2 2026 sales and H1 2026 results,” Jul. 23, 2026.

[7] Republic of Kazakhstan, “On Personal Data and their Protection,” May 21, 2013, Law No. 94-V, art. 5.

[12] Carrefour, “Carrefour integrates OpenAI technologies and launches a generative AI powered shopping experience,” Jun. 8, 2023.

[14] Magnum Cash&Carry, “About us,” n.d.

[15] Magnum Cash&Carry, “Magnum Club personal data privacy policy,” n.d.

[18] Republic of Kazakhstan, “About limited and additional liability partnerships,” Apr. 22, 1998, Law No. 220-I, arts. 2 and 41.

[19] Carrefour, “Carrefour devient le premier retailer européen à proposer de faire ses courses sur ChatGPT,” Mar. 26, 2026.

[20] SAS, “Carrefour s’appuie sur l’Intelligence Artificielle de l’éditeur SAS pour optimiser la gestion de sa supply chain et réduire le gaspillage des produits alimentaires,” Jan. 14, 2019.

[21] Carrefour, “Carrefour Group Suppliers Ethics Charter,” 2024 edition.

[22] Magnum Cash&Carry, “Corporate rules,” n.d.

Activity 3 AI Business Model Stress Test

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Company B: Magnum Cash&Carry Company A: Carrefour

Magnum should test forecasting and adapt catalogue search, retaining staff approval. The table separates existing activities from proposed AI uses and expected benefits.

Element	**Company B now**	**AI opportunity / change**	**Risk / VUCA pressure**	**Company A evidence**	**Verdict + why**
Customer / need	Magnum serves household shoppers and business buyers through retail and wholesale activities.	Help shoppers find available products through questions in Kazakh or Russian, reducing search effort.	Uncertainty: shoppers may prefer ordinary search. Language errors could suggest unsuitable products.	Carrefour, 8 Jun. 2023: Hopla connects questions about budgets, dietary needs and meals to product search.	**ADAPT**: use Magnum's catalogue and both languages. Test successful searches and retain staff help.
Value proposition	Stores provide access to goods. Magnum Club adds bonuses, discounts and offers based on customer interests.	Offer relevant basket suggestions; using purchase histories could extend personalisation beyond the shopper's current request.	Ambiguity: additional data may not improve relevance enough to justify privacy concerns.	Hopla responds to preferences supplied by shoppers. This supports useful suggestions without establishing a need for Magnum's purchase histories.	**DELAY** additional personalisation: establish purpose, privacy controls and benefits beyond existing offers. Start with the shopper's stated needs.
Delivery / process	Retail and wholesale operations require replenishment. The sources do not establish Magnum's forecasting method or stock-data quality.	Forecast demand by product and store; suggest quantities that category managers review before ordering.	Volatility: promotions or delivery changes can quickly alter demand and stock needs.	SAS, 14 Jan. 2019: Carrefour selected SAS Viya to improve forecasts and supplier ordering using store, warehouse and online data.	**PILOT** one category against current ordering. Compare stockouts and waste; retain manual approval because local accuracy is unproven.
Resources / activities	Magnum has store and commercial teams and a loyalty application. These sources do not establish AI capabilities.	Draft catalogue descriptions and support purchasing documents, while staff verify product facts and decisions.	Complexity: product data, suppliers, staff skills and software must work together. Errors add correction work.	Carrefour, 8 Jun. 2023: AI enriches product descriptions and supports tender drafting and quote analysis for non-retail purchasing.	**ADAPT** assistance to local products and workflows. **REJECT** autonomous approval for this trial; managers remain accountable.

Element	Company B now	AI opportunity / change	Risk / VUCA pressure	Company A evidence	Verdict + why
Revenue / value capture	Retail and wholesale sales generate revenue. Profit depends on covering goods and operating costs; loyalty discounts affect margins.	Reduce lost sales and waste through better availability. Deduct software, integration, training and correction costs from expected benefits.	Ambiguity: higher sales may reflect promotions rather than AI, and may not mean higher profit.	SAS links Carrefour's forecasting project to availability and reduced overstock. The announcement gives no measured return applicable to Magnum.	**PILOT** the business case. Finance and category managers should compare net benefits with current practice before expansion.

Sources: Carrefour, Magnum Cash&Carry and SAS. Proposed uses and verdicts are the analysis for Magnum.

Changed assumption

Suppose a promotion reveals that recorded stock differs from shelf stock. Forecasting changes from PILOT to DELAY until category managers reconcile the records. Search must then show only checked availability, staff need time to correct data, and the financial test must include that work. Retest against current ordering before expansion. This is a stress scenario, not a reported Magnum incident.

Sources

Sources checked 30 September 2026. Company and vendor announcements establish the examples; Magnum's results require local testing.

Carrefour. Carrefour integrates OpenAI technologies and launches a generative AI-powered shopping experience. 8 June 2023.

Magnum Cash&Carry. About us. undated.

Magnum Cash&Carry. Magnum Club personal data privacy policy. undated. Sections 2.4 and 4.3.

SAS. Carrefour uses AI to improve its supply chain and reduce food waste. 14 January 2019. Translated title; official SAS copy of the same release.